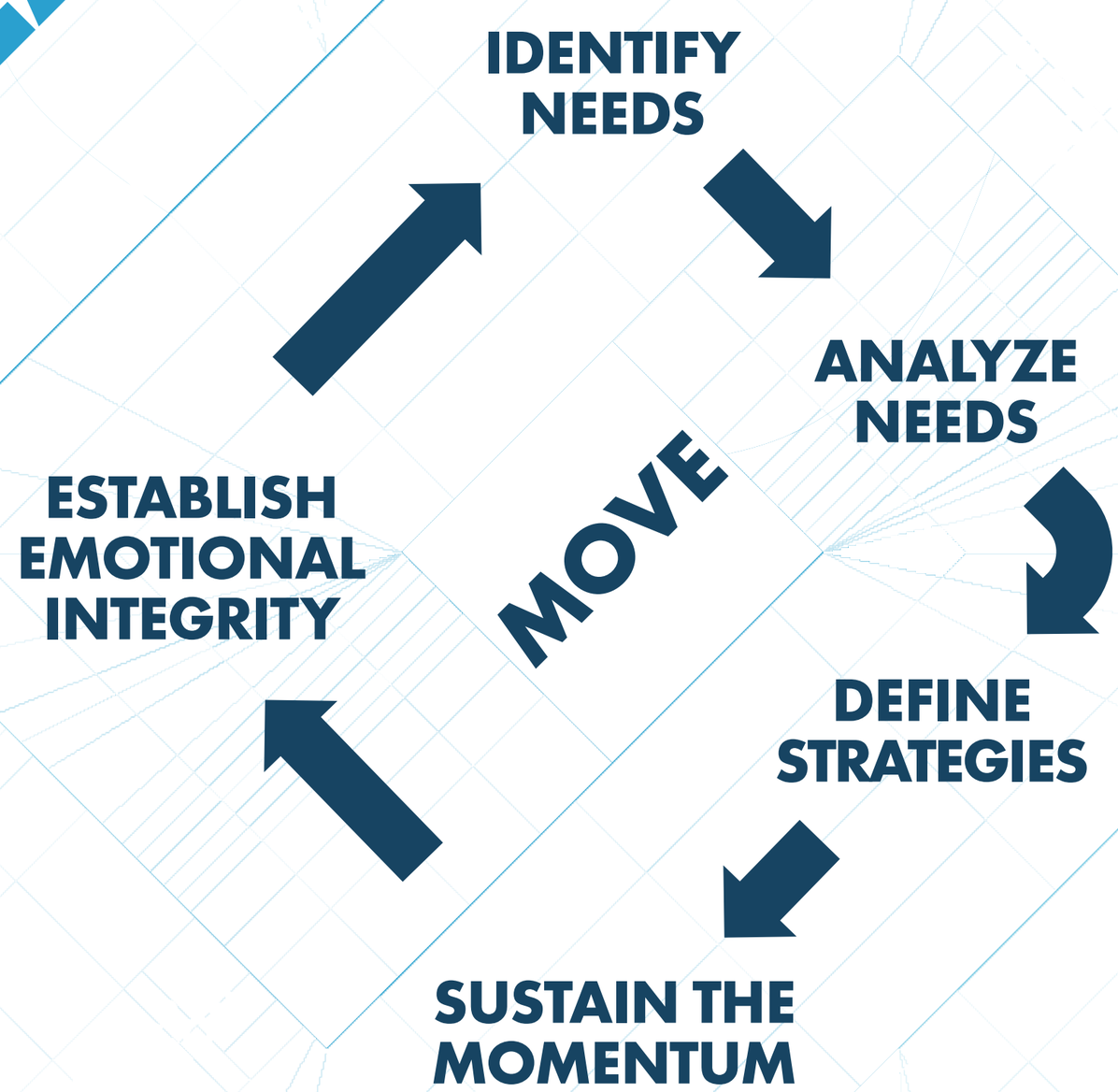
NEEDS-FOCUSED LEADERSHIP



ESTABLISH EMOTIONAL INTEGRITY

- Assess your current emotional state
- Recognize that emotions are contagious
- Adopt a forward-looking perspective
- Understand what pushes your buttons
- Prevent your empathy from diminishing

IDENTIFY NEEDS

- Identify specific underlying needs
- Be aware of emotional contagion
- Engage in active listening adapted to preferred communication styles
- Use educated guessing supported by reflective pausing
- Proactively address future tensions through empathetic validation

ANALYZE NEEDS

- Analyze needs based on values, interests, cultural factors, priority, and urgency
- Identify and manage competing or conflicting needs
- Distinguish between pronouncedness and actual level of fulfillment
- Proactively address biases and cognitive distortions using systems thinking
- Monitor stress levels and recognize mental health concerns

DEFINE STRATEGIES

- Differentiate internal from external strategic elements
- Avoid rushing prematurely into solutions
- Reactivate past positive connections
- Empower and inspire team members toward self-help
- Apply Strategy Zero by emotionally validating unmet needs

SUSTAIN THE MOMENTUM

- Regularly reassess team satisfaction and motivation
- Conduct dedicated "empathy checkpoints"
- Strategically align checkpoints with specific project milestones
- Maintain authenticity in monitoring processes
- Restart the cycle proactively when adjustments are needed

MOVE COMPETENCY MODEL

SYSTEM-RELATED & EXECUTION ELEMENTS

- Creating Clear Paths to Action
- Visionary & Growth-Oriented Leadership
- Systems-Oriented Problem Solving

RELATIONAL COMPETENCE

- Service-Oriented Leadership
- Facilitating Open Dialogue and Feedback
- Assertiveness
- Attentive and Empathetic Listening

PERSONAL MASTERY

- Impartial Thinking
- Emotional Balance
- Identifying & Managing Personal Triggers

TRUST

OPENNESS

- Transparent communication
- Open expression of one's thoughts and feelings
- Acceptance of others' perspectives
- Proactively addressing difficult topics
- Active, unbiased listening

RELIABILITY

- Integrity (alignment of words and actions)
- Keeping agreements and commitments
- Predictable and consistent behavior
- Creating reliable structures and frameworks
- Constructive handling of mistakes

GOOD FAITH

- Offering trust proactively („trust first")
- Positive mindset towards others
- Genuine concern for others' well-being
- Willingness to show vulnerability and accept potential disappointment
- Initiating shared positive experiences